EGBC: what we need answered

Reading KOR's own procedures, templates, minutes and signed contracts against the current EGBC standards turned up places where they disagree. Most need a **decision**, not research. A few need an **engineer's interpretation**. Some are **facts only someone in the office knows**.

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How to use this

Every item names what KOR's own paper says, what EGBC says, and the one question to settle. Each one carries the claim numbers behind it, so the source text can be pulled in seconds.

- **Part A** is for a principal. The EGBC rule is clear; KOR's practice or paperwork differs. The answer is a yes/no on changing it.
- **Part B** is for an engineer, or EGBC's practice advisors. The rules themselves are unclear, have changed, or conflict.
- **Part C** is for whoever runs the office side. They're facts about what is still in use.

✓ WHAT I COULD ANSWER WITHOUT ASKING

The EGBC position on every Part A item is stated plainly in the current Quality Management guides (v4.0/v5.0, September 2026), the Guide to the Letters of Assurance and the practice advisories. The older Permit to Practice manual (EGBC retired it) is not relied on anywhere below, except where Part B says so.

✕ WHAT THIS IS NOT

Not legal advice, and not an audit finding. These are documents read against standards. Some items may already be fixed in practice even though the old paper still says otherwise; Part C asks exactly that.

PART A · FOR A PRINCIPAL

Decisions: where KOR's documents conflict with EGBC

The first three are in **live templates** that go to clients today.

1. Letters of assurance held back over payment

Live template | Principal decides

- **KOR's paper:** the fee terms let KOR withdraw its letters of assurance when invoices are 60 days overdue, and give final documentation only after full payment. The office procedure has the office manager confirm the client has paid before a Schedule C-B is signed.
- **EGBC:** schedules and sealed documents are never withheld to collect a fee. Payment disputes are handled by suspending future work, not by holding the assurance.
- **The question:** strike the 60-day clause and the payment check on the C-B, and collect through suspension and earlier invoicing instead? Yes / No.

KOR: source 139 claims 43801, 43802; source 140 claim 44037. EGBC: Practice Advisory, Professional of Record in Contractual Disputes 41971–41973; Guide to the Letters of Assurance 41617, 41638, 41653; QM Guide Authentication 40582.

2. Field reviews capped by number

`Live template` `Principal decides`

- **KOR's paper:** the 2019 terms capped reviews at four per 8,000 sq ft. A late-cancelled visit counts as one of the included reviews. A signed Strand contract put "up to 40 field reviews" in the fee, and a Holborn scope had review frequency agreed with the contractor.
- **EGBC:** the engineer of record decides how many reviews are needed, by risk, and may not agree to a limit in advance.
- **The question:** change the wording so the number is an *estimate for fee purposes*, with extra reviews billed, never a ceiling on the work? Yes / No. (The exact wording is in Part B, question 9.)

KOR: source 140 claims 44001, 44058; source 138 claims 43460, 43473; source 137 claims 43293, 43336; source 139 claim 43708. EGBC: QM Guide Field Reviews v4.0 40686, 40687, 40693–40695.

3. Project records discarded or signed away

`Live procedure` `Principal decides`

- **KOR's paper:** the job-file clean-out discards meeting minutes, superseded architectural drawings, non-structural shop drawings and LEED scorecards. A Holborn contract (2018) required KOR to return and delete all confidential information within five days of termination.
- **EGBC:** the complete project record is kept for at least 10 years, and a contract cannot shorten that. Minutes record decisions; the architectural sets show what the structure was designed to.
- **The question:** change the clean-out list to keep minutes and the architectural sets, and refuse return-and-delete clauses in future (or carve out the 10-year record)? Yes / No.

KOR: source 140 claims 44022, 44023; source 137 claim 43288. EGBC: QM Guide Retention v4.0 40716–40743; Practice Advisory Retention and Disclosure 42091–42097; Practice Advisory Design-Build 41935.

4. Photos accepted in place of site visits

Minutes, 2023 Principal decides

- **KOR's paper:** the 2023 minutes record that site photos meet the field review requirement and cut travel, including for "ordinary columns, walls and stairs".
- **EGBC:** the engineer may choose methods and technology, with due diligence, but critical work must be seen while it is still visible, and photos must follow a record protocol to be a defensible record.
- **The question:** adopt a written, per-project list (approved by the engineer of record) of what photos may cover, with a photo protocol? Yes / No. (Whether EGBC accepts photos for vertical structure in a tower is Part B, question 8.)

KOR: source 138 claims 43483, 43484, 43495. EGBC: QM Guide Field Reviews v4.0 40683, 40685, 40696, 40710, 40712.

5. Field reports issued a month late

Procedure Principal decides

- **KOR's paper:** a copy is left on site the same day, but reports reach recipients in the first week of the next month, subcontracted inspectors' reports wait for their invoice, and the engineer of record initials them in a monthly batch. Busy-week visits are handed out by email, and partner firms do routine visits with no written scope on file.
- **EGBC:** deficiencies are reported in writing at the time and copied to the owner. Reviews done by someone else are recorded, including why that person was fit to do them.
- **The question:** set a standard: engineer of record initials within two working days, deficiencies out the same week, and a written scope for every delegated or partner-firm visit? Yes / No.

KOR: source 140 claims 44016, 44017, 44020, 44099; source 138 claims 43461, 43470, 43482. EGBC: QM Guide Field Reviews v4.0 40702, 40713; QM Guide Direct Supervision v4.0 40626, 40628–40633.

▸ ALSO IN PART A TERRITORY (SMALLER)

- **Sealing on another partner's behalf.** The office procedure says that on jobs needing a Struct.Eng., a Struct.Eng. partner "signs and seals on behalf of" a lead partner without it. EGBC allows sealing only what you prepared or directly supervised. Decide: name the Struct.Eng. partner as engineer of record at job set-up. (source 140 claim 44047; EGBC 40512, 40580, 40581, 40614)
- **Engineering direction on site.** Reviewers phone the engineer, then give the instruction on site. EGBC: reviewers report the problem, and the fix is the engineer of record's sealed instruction. (source 138 claim 43478; EGBC 40699, 40708)
- **Seismic memo wording.** The client memo says the code aims to "prevent collapse and limit damage". EGBC's tall-building guideline says the objective is life safety, with no damage limit for a normal building. Decide: correct the template. (source 140 claim 44055; EGBC 41040)
- **1993 material in the office procedures.** The 1993 APEGBC guideline text, an "as-built" definition, and records kept "to meet Bylaw 14(b)". Decide: one pass to replace it. (source 140 claims 44091, 44130, 44134)
- **Specification templates.** These carry stale text: the 2006 Alberta Building Code and a predecessor firm in a Burnaby spec, another firm's name as "the Engineer", CSA S269.3 (replaced by S269.1-16). Decide: one master spec with an owner. (source 141 claims 44206, 44240, 44341)

PART B · FOR AN ENGINEER, OR EGBC

Where the rules themselves need interpreting

6. When must independent review be finished?

- **The conflict:** EGBC's tall concrete building guideline (v1.0) says independent review is required before issue for construction, with some authorities wanting it at permit. The newer Independent Review standard (v4.0, September 2026) and the Issued-for-Building-Permit advisory require it to be complete *before the building permit application*.
- **My reading:** the newer standard governs, so finish the review before the permit submission and price it into the permit phase.
- **Ask:** is that right for every KOR job type? Does any authority KOR works with still accept review at construction issue?

Claims 41072 (tall concrete guideline) vs 40794 (Independent Review v4.0); 41911 (IFBP advisory) supports 40794.

7. Is a yearly firm competence review still required?

- **The gap:** the requirement for a yearly review of each engineer's competence appears only in the old Permit to Practice manual, which EGBC retired when it issued the v4.0 QM guides (September 2026). I could not find it restated in the current guides.
- **Ask:** does KOR's Permit to Practice still need a documented yearly competence review, and in what form? If you're not sure, put this one to EGBC's practice advisors.

Retirement: claim 40761. Retired manual: source 92.

8. Photos for vertical structure in a tower

- **The rule:** EGBC lets the engineer of record choose methods, including technology, but says critical work must be seen while visible.
- **Ask:** in a concrete tower, which elements does a KOR engineer of record consider critical (always seen in person), and which may a photo review cover? This becomes the per-project list in item 4.

EGBC: 40683, 40685, 40696, 40712.

9. Wording for a field review estimate

- **Proposed wording:** "The fee includes an estimated *N* field reviews for budgeting. The engineer of record determines the number and timing of reviews required; reviews beyond the estimate are billed at the rates in Schedule A."
- **Ask:** does this meet EGBC's "no advance limit" rule while still protecting the fee? Is anything to be added or removed?

EGBC: 40687, 40693.

10. Where KOR departs from a guideline: what record is needed?

- **The open question:** in 2022 the Engineering Committee asked whether KOR must follow the tall concrete building guideline when the building code is already met. It flagged three items (500-grade steel, 100% code wind loads, header shear redistribution, where KOR accepts 10%) and left the question open.
- **EGBC:** meet the intent of relevant guidelines, and record in writing the reasons for any departure.
- **Ask:** what is KOR's position on each of the three? Who signs the written rationale, and where does it live?

KOR: source 138 claims 43558, 43576, 43582. EGBC: QM Guide Use of Practice Guidelines v3.0 40748, 40750.

11. Contracts that demand deletion of records

- **Ask:** where a signed contract requires return and deletion (Holborn), does KOR keep the 10-year record regardless, since EGBC says a contract can't shorten it? Should the broker or legal counsel confirm the wording for future markups?

EGBC: 42094, 41935. KOR: source 137 claim 43288.

PART C · FOR THE OFFICE

Facts only someone at KOR knows

- **Which fee terms are current?** Is the 2019 version (with the review cap and the 60-day assurance clause) still the one sent today, or has it been replaced?
- **Which problem contracts are still live?** Strand ("up to 40 reviews"; "highest standard"; deemed-to-include scope), Holborn (warranty; return-and-delete; ownership of drawings), Wesgroup (indemnity carve-outs) and Solterra (meetings and redesign free).
- **Engineer-of-record changes in 2018 and 2024.** One principal covered a colleague's duties for a month in 2018, and a retiring principal handed over in October 2024, both by internal letter. Were the authorities told in writing, and were new Schedules issued? EGBC treats this as a formal transfer. (source 140 claims 44061, 44062; EGBC 41638–41658)
- **Field report turnaround today.** Is it still monthly, or has it already changed?
- **Who owns the office procedures (the Project Practice Management Plan) and the master specification?** One name each.
- **Administrators' hours.** Not EGBC, but found in the same procedures: administrators are left out of weekly timesheets, yet the BC Employment Standards Act requires daily hours to be recorded for them. Payroll to confirm. (source 140 claim 44049; ESA 39649, 39720)

PART D · WHAT WOULD MAKE THE ANSWERS BETTER

Gaps in what we have

- **Alberta (APEGA).** KOR practises in Alberta, and 40 of the 110 live pursuits are there, but the knowledge base holds no APEGA documents. Ask: which APEGA practice standards does a KOR engineer use (permit to practice, authentication, retention, field review)? The PDFs can be loaded like the EGBC set.

- **EGBC documents in daily use.** We hold 43 EGBC documents (QM guides, bylaws, guidelines, bulletins, advisories). Ask the engineer which ones they actually open that might be missing, such as a structural guideline for Part 9 or post-disaster buildings.
- **KOR's employment practices.** M: holds no handbook or HR policy, so employment-law items can only be checked against the law, not against KOR's own policy.

SUGGESTED

A 30-minute session with the engineer

10 min · Part A, items 1–3 The three live-template conflicts. Yes/no on each; I draft the marked-up templates for approval.

10 min · Part B, items 6–9 Independent review timing, competence review, photo list, field review wording.

5 min · Part B, item 10 The three tall-building departures, and who signs the record.

5 min · Part C and D Who owns what; which APEGA documents to load.

◇ WHAT HAPPENS WITH THE ANSWERS

Each answer is written back into KOR's rules (the doctrine the morning brief draws on), citing "KOR principal, date". KOR's stated practice then outranks the books and the generic guidance everywhere the brief uses it.

Prepared from KOR's knowledge base: 143 sources, including 43 EGBC documents and 7 bodies of KOR's own documents from the Management share. Every claim number cited resolves to a passage with its page reference. Nothing was sent to anyone.

`Source text for any claim: BD Director → Doctrine, or BdKnowledgeIngest claims show <id>.`